PROactive PRONUNCIATION

De-Stressed Words

These are the words to really rush through quickly, almost deleting the vowel in the word entirely. Beside each word is how the term can be pronounced in its reduced form. Often, to destress a word, we neutralize the vowel to schwa "uh."

a "uh"
an "uhn"
and "uhn"
are "er"
as "uhz"
at "uht"
because "buhkuz"
can "cuhn"
for "fer"
in "n"
of "uhv and uh"
or "er"
our "ahr"
to "tuh" (if followed by a vowel, then it is "too")
you "yuh"
your "yer"
the "thuh"

Pronouns (he, she, me, they, we, I, them, etc.) become reduced or unstressed.

Sentences: (Rush through the underlined destressed words)

Where's the remote?
What's the time?
She can do it
I'm going to leave
She has a lot to say
I'm learning to speak Spanish
I'm going to go to the grocery store
You'll need to get there on time
He's one of a kind
Was that for you?

He’s on his way to the store
I have to find a washroom right now
You are kind and sweet
It’s as big as a mountain
You have to line up one at a time
Leave your umbrella at home today
I knew it because she told me yesterday
One by one, they came into the office
I can take your next order
It’s for you
I can see you
Practice your pronunciation
I was going to pick you up later tonight
As far as I can tell, the show is canceled
There’s one for you and one for me
It’s one and the same
I found the document on my computer
You can come to **my** place, or I can come to **your** place
He can drive you there
How are you doing today?
He’s been feeling pretty down and out lately
Was this piece of cake mine or yours?
You left your phone at **my** place
This is our favorite place to eat